TECH TALK

How FDEs Drive Mainframe Modernization Momentum

From customer-code proof to production outcomes

October 2, 2026

PRE-SALES | DELIVERY | PRODUCT | PARTNER

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SECTION 01

The Problem and the Opportunity

Why modernization stalls, and what a momentum motion changes.

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Modernization stalls when evidence and ownership break

TRADITIONAL MOTION

Years to align, assess, scope and procure

- Feasibility debated before customer-code proof
- Knowledge recreated at every handoff
- Production owner selected after the POC
- Success measured by activity—not launch

MOMENTUM MOTION

Weeks to prove a bounded outcome on real code

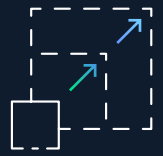
- Evidence precedes the production decision
- Assessment context travels with the code
- Delivery capacity is named at intake
- Success measured by production momentum

FDEs preserve momentum across the seams: proof → product learning → production → scale

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How FDE can help



Overcoming inertia

Undecided on mainframe modernization: analyze code & data, extracted business rules, and transform your business applications to cloud native architecture through hands-on; not a presentation pitch



Breaking analysis paralysis

Approvals stalled: reimagine one bounded component and finish at an EBA-ready demo within weeks



Accelerating time-to-market

Already started with AWS Transform and AI Agents: a FDE pairs with your team to share the learnings from other customers, equip you with the reusable tools, and helps accelerate your transformation journey

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How FDE operates

SIDE-BY-SIDE, IN YOUR SANDBOX



AWS SPECIALIST **YOUR ENGINEER**

BUILDS ALONGSIDE YOUR ENGINEERING TEAM

pairing frequently — your people learn as we build

REIMAGINE mainframe app → **BUILD** together → **PROTOTYPE** working code

WHAT YOU GET

WORKING PROTOTYPE IN YOUR SANDBOX

modern, cloud-native code on your AWS account

YOUR TEAM UPSKILLED

knowledge stays with you

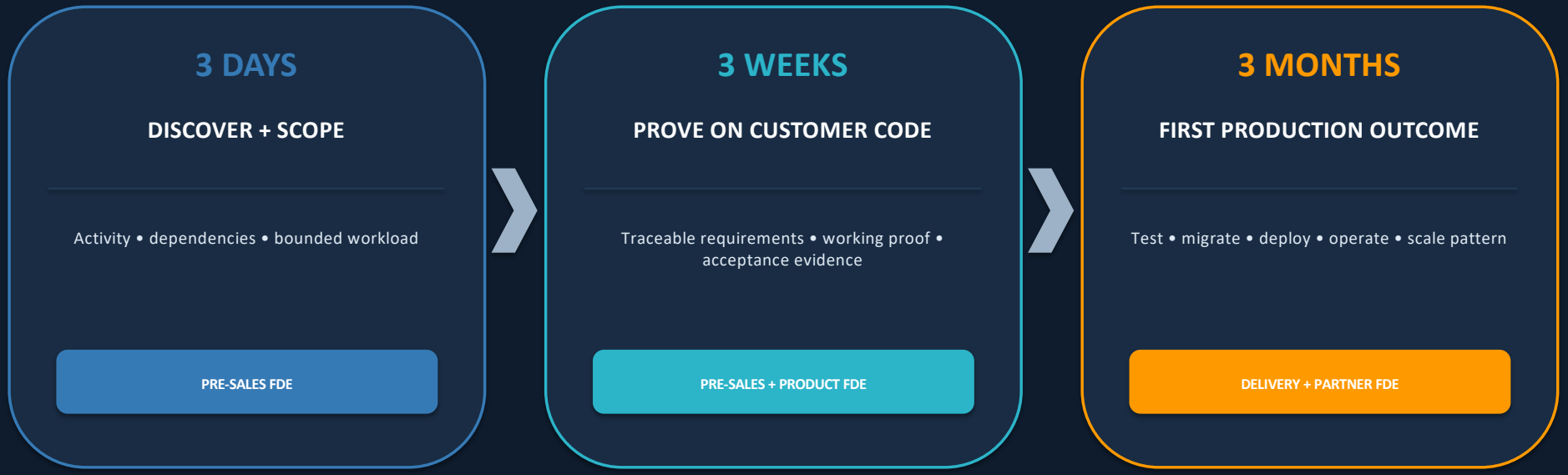
EVIDENCE TO DECIDE

the path forward, de-risked before you commit

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3-3-3 compresses learning without skipping production rigor

CDE / pre-sales FDE owns assessment + proof; delivery capacity owns production.



Momentum rule: name the production owner before the proof closes

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SECTION 02

What Forward-Deployed Engineering Is

The operating model, the four FDE modes, and the lifecycle they map to.

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Forward-deployed engineering is an operating model—not a handoff

FDEs combine deep domain context with hands-on engineering inside the customer's transformation journey.

1

CODE OVER SLIDES

Build on the customer's actual estate

2

EVIDENCE OVER ESTIMATES

Show traceable output before asking for scale

3

CONTINUITY OVER HANDOFFS

Carry context from proof into production

4

OUTCOME OVER ACTIVITY

Measure launch, learning and repeatability

The role changes by phase; the engineering principle stays constant.

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Four FDE modes—one production motion

Use these as operating modes; naming and employment models vary by organization.

01

PRE-SALES FDE

Remove decision risk

Customer-authorized non-production

Scope • reverse engineer • bounded proof

02

DELIVERY FDE

Turn proof into production

Committed / contracted delivery

Build • test • migrate • launch

03

PRODUCT FDE

Turn field gaps into capability

Product co-design + roadmap

Reproduce • validate • generalize

04

PARTNER FDE

Scale patterns across the estate

Partner-owned commercial delivery

Accept proof • deploy • repeat

Boundary check: a pre-sales proof is not a production warranty

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Map roles to the work—not to a single title



Source → requirements → architecture → code → tests → production evidence

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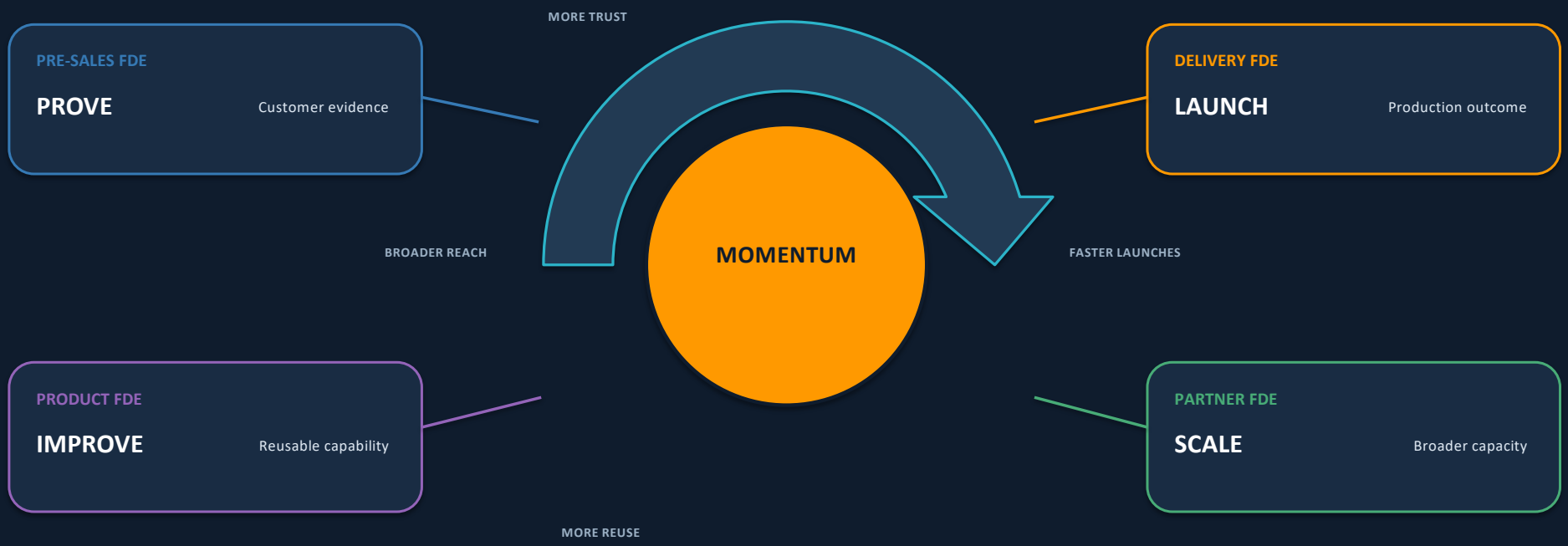
SECTION 03

How It Works

The flywheel, the toolchain, and the target architecture.

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Each production outcome makes the next engagement faster



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Deterministic evidence + flexible engineering + production rigor



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Modernize each decision according to the behavior it requires

Reimagination is not line-by-line translation into a new language.

AGENTIC LAYER

Judgment, triage, routing, recommendations

Payment exceptions • fraud follow-up • document intake

INTEROPERABILITY LAYER

APIs, events, identity, policy and data contracts

Expose core capability safely to people and agents

DETERMINISTIC CORE

Repeatable, traceable and auditable business logic

Ledger • policy • eligibility • calculations

CHOOSE THE RIGHT PATTERN

AGENTS	Reasoning-heavy exceptions
MICROSERVICES	Deterministic business services
DATA + EVENTS	State, reconciliation and integration

Design from validated requirements—not the legacy topology

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SECTION 04

Proof and Putting It to Work

A customer story, a practical checklist, and the takeaways.

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Unum: connect reverse engineering to a new application workflow

Public-reference example; validate final customer-approved wording before broadcast.

CHALLENGE

Disability claims

Legacy COBOL application
≈1.5M lines of code

Modernize the workflow—not simply translate the code

CUSTOMER-CODE START

AWS TRANSFORM

Analyze + decompose
Extract business logic

PEGA BLUEPRINT

Generate application workflows

PEGA CLOUD ON AWS

Deploy the modern experience

REPORTED OUTCOMES

2× faster application delivery

7,000 person-hours saved

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Start with a bounded decision and design the production path on day one

1

BUSINESS OUTCOME + SPONSOR

Name the workflow, decision or customer outcome that creates value

2

BOUNDED WORKLOAD

Select customer code that can answer one feasibility question

3

AUTHORIZED NON-PROD ACCESS

Agree data controls, environment and approved tooling

4

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

Define architecture, traceability and proof evidence

5

PRODUCTION FDE NAMED

Attach partner, delivery team or customer factory before proof exit

6

TEST + DATA + OPERATIONS PLAN

Plan equivalence, migration, security, observability and ownership

SUCCESS MEASURE = FIRST PRODUCTION OUTCOME, NOT POC COMPLETION

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Getting started with FDE

WHAT YOU BRING

- **A NON-PROD SANDBOX**
  an environment you nominate — least-privilege, time-bound access
- **DE-RISKED SAMPLE DATA**
  synthetic, public, or attested clean — no PII, no production data
- **ENGINEERS TO PAIR**
  builds side-by-side with the AWS specialist — knowledge stays with you
- **AI TOOLING APPROVAL**
  AWS Transform + Amazon Neptune + Kiro / Claude Code /Codex approved for setup on your AWS account
- **ONE BOUNDED COMPONENT**
  programs, transactions, or batch jobs within a bounded context if you are already aware

WHAT HAPPENS NEXT

1. **SCOPE WITH YOUR ACCOUNT TEAM**
   agree component, environment & guardrails — no SOW, no charge
2. **ASSESS WITH AWS TRANSFORM**
   activity analysis & business-rule extraction on a representative sample
3. **BUILD, VALIDATE & DEMO**
   time-boxed reimagine PoC ending in an EBA-ready demo
4. **HANDOVER TO PRODUCTION**
   ProServe or a partner takes the prototype forward — beyond FDE, via SOW

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Momentum is continuity from customer code to production

1 ONE SYSTEM

Pre-sales, product, delivery and partner FDEs solve different gaps

2 EVIDENCE TRAVELS

Assessment context, code and tests move together

3 PRODUCTION COUNTS

Measure the launched workload and repeatable scale pattern

RESOURCES

- **AWS Transform for mainframe** — https://aws.amazon.com/transform/mainframe/
- **AWS Transform mainframe workflow documentation** — https://docs.aws.amazon.com/transform/latest/userguide/transform-app-mainframe-workflow.html
- **Pega + AWS modernization announcement** — https://www.pega.com/de/about/news/press-releases/pega-launches-ai-driven-modernization-capability-aws-reimagine-legacy
- **Webinar registration / share link** — https://amazon.webex.com/webappng/sites/amazon/webinar/webinarSeries/register/f8d0fb3d8cdd42b4bf2671605e584329

Q&A

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TECH TALK

Thank you

Momentum is continuity from customer code to production.

Questions and discussion welcome

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